

D561

Information Systems for Accounting and Control

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	------------------------	----------------------------------

Items

1.

An attacker changes the bank account numbers in an accounting firm's vendor master file so payments go to the attacker. The firm's data center is in a secure building with badge access. Which part of the CIA triad is most directly compromised?

- A. Integrity.
- B. Confidentiality.
- C. Physical security of the data center.
- D. Availability.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A CFO emails a signed wire authorization to the company's bank. The bank must confirm the message came from the CFO and was not altered. The CFO uses a laptop issued last month. Which key does the CFO use to create the digital signature?

- A. The bank's public key.
- B. A shared symmetric key both parties hold.
- C. The CFO's public key.
- D. The CFO's private key.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company wants to send a payroll file that only its bank can read. Using asymmetric encryption, which key should encrypt the file?

- A. The bank's private key.
- B. The bank's public key.
- C. The company's private key.
- D. The company's public key.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A mid-size accounting firm wants staff working from home and hotels to reach the client file server over the internet without exposing the traffic to eavesdroppers. The firm has 45 employees and a new office lease. Which control fits best?

- A. An intrusion detection system.
- B. A virtual private network (VPN).
- C. A firewall.
- D. Opening the server to the internet with strong passwords, which always prevents eavesdropping.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A company backs up its ERP database every 6 hours, at 12 a.m., 6 a.m., 12 p.m. and 6 p.m. A server fails at 4:30 p.m., and restoring takes 3 hours. The ERP was customized by an outside partner. How much data is lost in this event, and which objective does the backup schedule set?

- A. 6 hours of data; the RPO.
- B. 4.5 hours of data; the RTO.
- C. 3 hours of data; the RPO.
- D. 4.5 hours of data; the backup schedule sets the RPO.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Management says payroll must be back online within 2 hours of an outage and that no more than 15 minutes of transactions may be lost. What is the RTO?

- A. 15 minutes.
- B. 2 hours 15 minutes.
- C. 2 hours.
- D. Zero, because any outage is unacceptable.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A controller wants to analyze five years of sales by region, product and quarter without slowing down the live order-entry system. The company's order volume peaks every December. Where should the analysis run?

- A. In each salesperson's own spreadsheet.
- B. On the backup tapes, since backups hold all history.
- C. Directly on the live transaction database.
- D. In a data warehouse built for analysis.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A U.S. tax-preparation firm stores clients' Social Security numbers, bank account numbers and income data. The firm has offices in two states and a popular podcast. Which U.S. federal law most directly requires it to safeguard this customer information?

- A. The Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act (GLBA).
- B. HIPAA.
- C. The Sarbanes-Oxley Act.
- D. The GDPR.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which law requires management of public companies to assess and report on internal control over financial reporting?

- A. GLBA.
- B. The Sarbanes-Oxley Act.
- C. HIPAA.
- D. PCI DSS.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An accounting firm requires staff to enter a password and then answer a security question to log in to its tax software. The firm's IT manager calls this multi-factor authentication. The firm upgraded its Wi-Fi last month. Is this MFA?

- A.** Yes, if the security question is hard to guess.
- B.** Yes; two steps means two factors.
- C.** No; both are knowledge factors, so it is single-factor.
- D.** No, because MFA always requires a fingerprint.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which login pairing is true multi-factor authentication?

- A.** A password plus a code from an authenticator app on the user's phone.
- B.** A fingerprint plus a face scan.
- C.** Two different passwords.
- D.** A password plus a PIN.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

The payroll application rejects any entry of more than 80 hours per week for a single employee. The payroll team works in a new office in Phoenix. What type of control is this?

- A.** A general IT control.
- B.** A detective output control.
- C.** An application input control (a limit check).
- D.** A physical access control for the new office.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

An attacker changes the bank account numbers in an accounting firm's vendor master file so payments go to the attacker. ~~The firm's data center is in a secure building with badge access.~~ Which part of the CIA triad is most directly compromised?

Target word: CIA element **Decides:** Data was altered.

A	Correct	Unauthorized changes to data compromise integrity.
B	Confusion set	The problem is changed data, not exposed data.
C	Camouflage	Badge access is irrelevant to a logical change of records.
D	Adjacent category	The system stayed usable; its data was wrong.

2. Answer D Concept 2

A CFO emails a signed wire authorization to the company's bank. The bank must confirm the message came from the CFO and was not altered. ~~The CFO uses a laptop issued last month.~~ Which key does the CFO use to create the digital signature?

Target word: signing key **Decides:** Signatures use the sender's private key.

A	Confusion set	That key encrypts for secrecy, not for proving the sender.
B	Adjacent category	A shared key cannot show which party created the message.
C	Inverted operation	The public key verifies signatures; it cannot prove who signed.
D	Correct	Only the CFO holds it; anyone can verify with the CFO's public key.

3. Answer B Concept 2 · transfer

A company wants to send a payroll file that only its bank can read. Using asymmetric encryption, which key should encrypt the file?

Target word: encryption key **Decides:** Secrecy for the recipient.

A	Inverted operation	The company never has the bank's private key.
B	Correct	Only the bank's private key can decrypt it.
C	Confusion set	That creates a signature anyone can verify, not secrecy.
D	Adjacent category	Only the company could then decrypt it.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A mid-size accounting firm wants staff working from home and hotels to reach the client file server over the internet without exposing the traffic to eavesdroppers. ~~The firm has 45 employees and a new office lease.~~ Which control fits best?

Target word: network tool **Decides:** Remote traffic over untrusted networks needs encryption.

A	Confusion set	Detects attacks; it does not protect data in transit.
B	Correct	A VPN encrypts the tunnel between remote users and the network.
C	Adjacent category	Filters traffic but does not encrypt remote sessions.
D	Absolute language	Passwords do not encrypt traffic.

5. Answer D Concept 4

A company backs up its ERP database every 6 hours, at 12 a.m., 6 a.m., 12 p.m. and 6 p.m. A server fails at 4:30 p.m., and restoring takes 3 hours. ~~The ERP was customized by an outside partner.~~ How much data is lost in this event, and which objective does the backup schedule set?

Target word: data loss and metric **Decides:** Last backup at 12 p.m.; backup frequency sets the RPO.

A	Wrong stem number	Six hours is the worst case, not this event's loss.
B	Adjacent category	RTO is downtime, not data loss.
C	Confusion set	Three hours is restore time, which relates to the RTO.
D	Correct	Data since 12 p.m. is lost; backup frequency governs the recovery point.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

Management says payroll must be back online within 2 hours of an outage and that no more than 15 minutes of transactions may be lost. What is the RTO?

Target word: identify RTO **Decides:** RTO is allowed downtime.

A	Inverted operation	That is the RPO.
B	Adjacent category	Adds two different measures.
C	Correct	Maximum acceptable downtime is the RTO.
D	Absolute language	Management set a 2-hour tolerance.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A controller wants to analyze five years of sales by region, product and quarter without slowing down the live order-entry system. ~~The company's order volume peaks every December.~~ Where should the analysis run?

Target word: system choice **Decides:** Historical, multi-dimension analysis separate from operations.

A	Dropped element	Drops integration and control over a single source of data.
B	Adjacent category	Backups are for recovery, not analysis.
C	Confusion set	Heavy queries slow order entry.
D	Correct	Warehouses hold integrated history and keep query load off operations.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A U.S. tax-preparation firm stores clients' Social Security numbers, bank account numbers and income data. ~~The firm has offices in two states and a popular podcast.~~ Which U.S. federal law most directly requires it to safeguard this customer information?

Target word: applicable law **Decides:** Consumer financial data held by a tax preparer.

A	Correct	Tax preparers are financial institutions under GLBA's safeguards rules.
B	Confusion set	HIPAA covers health information.
C	Adjacent category	SOX covers public companies' financial reporting controls.
D	Confusion set	GDPR is EU law for EU residents' data.

9. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

Which law requires management of public companies to assess and report on internal control over financial reporting?

Target word: law from requirement — reverse **Decides:** Public-company reporting controls.

A	Confusion set	GLBA protects consumer financial information.
B	Correct	Section 404 requires management's assessment of ICFR.
C	Adjacent category	HIPAA covers health information privacy and security.
D	Adjacent category	An industry card-data standard, not a federal law.

10. Answer C Concept 7

An accounting firm requires staff to enter a password and then answer a security question to log in to its tax software. The firm's IT manager calls this multi-factor authentication. ~~The firm upgraded its Wi-Fi last month.~~ Is this MFA?

Target word: is it MFA **Decides:** Both are something you know.

A	Adjacent category	Strength does not change the factor category.
B	Confusion set	Steps are not factors; categories are.
C	Correct	MFA needs different factor categories.
D	Absolute language	A possession factor such as a phone app also works.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

Which login pairing is true multi-factor authentication?

Target word: pick valid MFA **Decides:** Two different categories.

A	Correct	Something you know plus something you have.
B	Adjacent category	Both are something you are.
C	Dropped element	Drops the need for a second category.
D	Confusion set	Both are something you know.

12. Answer C Concept 8

The payroll application rejects any entry of more than 80 hours per week for a single employee. ~~The payroll team works in a new office in Phoenix.~~ What type of control is this?

Target word: control type **Decides:** A field-level check inside one application.

A	Confusion set	General controls cover the IT environment, not one field's edits.
B	Adjacent category	It rejects entries up front rather than reviewing output.
C	Correct	It validates specific data as it is entered.
D	Camouflage	Office location has nothing to do with data validation.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	13	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	3	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	12	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The CIA triad	Confidentiality keeps data from unauthorized eyes; integrity keeps data accurate and unaltered; availability keeps systems usable when needed.	Calling any breach a confidentiality problem.	Whether data was seen, changed, or made unavailable.
2	Asymmetric keys and digital signatures	Sign with the sender's private key (verified with the sender's public key); encrypt for secrecy with the recipient's public key.	Swapping which key signs and which encrypts.	A need to prove who sent something vs. keep it secret.
3	Network security tools	A VPN encrypts traffic over untrusted networks; a firewall filters traffic by rules; an IDS detects suspicious activity.	Thinking a firewall or IDS encrypts remote sessions.	Remote users connecting over public internet.
4	RPO and RTO	Recovery point objective is the maximum acceptable data loss, set by backup frequency; recovery time objective is the maximum acceptable downtime.	Confusing restore time with data loss.	A backup schedule, a failure time, and a restore time.
5	Transaction systems vs. data warehouses	Operational (OLTP) databases process daily transactions; data warehouses (OLAP) hold integrated history for analysis without slowing operations.	Running heavy analysis on the live transaction system.	Multi-year analysis by several dimensions.
6	Which privacy or control law applies	GLBA protects consumer financial information held by financial institutions (including tax preparers); HIPAA covers health information; SOX covers public-company financial reporting controls; GDPR covers EU residents' data.	Picking the best-known law rather than the one that fits the data and entity.	The type of data and the type of organization.
7	Multi-factor authentication	MFA requires factors from different categories: something you know, have, or are.	Counting two items from the same category as two factors.	A login with two steps.
8	Application vs. general IT controls	Application controls operate inside a specific application on its transactions (input, processing, output); general IT controls cover the environment (access, change management, operations).	Calling a field-level edit check a general control.	A rule that rejects specific data entries.

Course scope (public description): Information Systems I is intended to provide learners with an overview of information systems and information system technology used in the world of accounting. The topics will include networks, hardware, data needs, cybersecurity, and government compliance with privacy and personal information. The course covers a range of topics that accountants may experience and be responsible for in their professional life. There are four competencies, and each competency will introduce learners to topics designed to prepare them for the high-stakes assessment.